# Performance and Promotion Policy

*Kestrel Data Labs Pvt. Ltd. (fictional company created for this project)*

## *1. Review cycles*

Performance is reviewed twice a year, in April and October. Each review includes a self-assessment, manager assessment and, for levels L4 and above, feedback from at least three peers.

## *2. Rating scale*

Employees are rated on a 5-point scale: 1 Does not meet expectations, 2 Partially meets, 3 Meets, 4 Exceeds, 5 Outstanding. Ratings are calibrated across each department before they are shared.

## *3. Career levels*

The career framework has levels L1 (entry) to L8 (principal / director). Each level has a published description of expected scope and impact.

## *4. Promotion eligibility*

To be eligible for promotion, an employee must have spent at least 18 months in their current level and must have received a rating of 4 or higher in each of the last two review cycles. Promotions take effect from 1 May or 1 November, following the review cycle.

## *5. Performance improvement plan*

An employee rated 1 in a cycle, or rated 2 in two consecutive cycles, is placed on a Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) of 60 days with clear, measurable goals and fortnightly check-ins.

## *6. Salary review*

Annual salary revisions are effective from 1 April and are linked to the April review rating and market benchmarks.